

Impersonal: You can't customise Chrome like you can Firefox or Opera — yet.

Controls: There's a lack of possible parental controls, and Chrome omits the settings to be able to block particular Web sites but allow others. Merely providing the browser with a "Block all Insecure Content" or "Block all cookies" options, does not make the browsing experience any safer for children.

Flash files: Typically, a Web site using Adobe's Flash plug-in gobbles up a lot of space on your CPU, greatly slowing down the Web experience. This is a common problem with Firefox (try opening ten sites with Flash content at the same time) and something similar happens with Chrome — though not to such an extent. Using the Task Manager in Chrome, however, is a step in the right direction, because then you could at least close the windows that are using up too much memory.

So Which One's The Best?

The pros and cons of each browser may not be good enough to help you reach a decision, so we decided to put it all together in a table (on the previous page). This simple and quick overview can help you to arrive at the right browser for you.

The Verdict

More than three quarters of the world uses

Internet Explorer, and doesn't seem to be changing over in a hurry. If you're one of them, there's good news for you. The Microsoft team scores high on speed, ease, security, functionality and customisation. The use of colours to allow the end-user to identify the tabs that form a common group is one big leap forward and the Web Slices and Accelerators are the icing on the cake. So, in spite of it not being free for all, and not being a part of the GNU project, the fact remains that most apps in the world are still made for IE; and it therefore, rules the roost.

On the other hand, Chrome is great for its new features and super-fast browsing; Opera is terrific for its customisation options, speed and Opera Mobile has left the others far behind when it comes to cell phones; Firefox is also good, with 24×7 security volunteers, a new look, and thousands of add-ons. If we're absolutely forced to give you a rating, keeping security in mind as well, we'd say it's IE8 Beta 2 on top, Mozilla Firefox and Opera tied in second place and Chrome trailing — for now.

It all boils down to your personal preferences. Depending on whether you prefer a snazzy interface, an ultra-quick Web experience or a browser for social networking, you will have to choose for yourself. Regardless of which browser you choose, you're assured a faster, safer and more pleasurable browsing experience than ever before. Happy surfing. ☒



Browser comparison

Features	Firefox	Google Chrome	Internet Explorer	Opera
Tabbed Browsing	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Integrated Search Engine	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Smart Locator	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Thumbnail Preview	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Customization	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
RSS Feeds	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Password Manager	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Zoom	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Open Source	Yes	Yes	No	No
Download Manager	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Form Manager	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Spell Check	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Pop-up Blocker	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Anti-Spyware/Phishing/Virus	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Private Browsing	No	Yes	Yes	No
Online Support	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Initial Startup Speed	Very Slow	Fast	Slow	Very Fast
Average Startup Speed	Slow	Fast	Very fast	Fast
Navigation Speed	Very fast	Fast	Slow	Fast
Free to Download	Yes	Yes	No (unless you already use licensed Windows)	Yes
Layout Engine	Gecko	WebKit	Trident	Presto
Runs on Linux (without Emulation)	Yes	No	No	Yes
No. of Languages it's available in	46	43	25 (IE 8 Beta 2)	31